Roman Zaiev

Senior Software Engineer | Technical Founder
15 years of professional experience

London, UK (settled, no visa required)
roman@zaiev.net · linkedin.com/in/zaiev
github.com/zaiev · hypha.pub

Software engineer with 15 years of experience designing and building production systems end-to-end — from high-load e-commerce platforms and fintech infrastructure to an early-stage video platform with on-chain payments.

Known for building systems that are simple, elegant, and reliable for the long run.

I operate best in environments that value technical depth, vision and ownership, alongside talented and self-motivated people on problems that matter.

Looking for a senior engineering role with room to grow and long-term impact.

LANGUAGES
English (C1) · Ukrainian (native) · Russian (native)
Python (expert) · JavaScript & TypeScript · Familiar with Rust, Go, OCaml, Clojure

STACK
FastAPI · PostgreSQL · Redis · DuckDB
Solid.js · React · HTMX
FreeBSD / Jails · Linux / Docker / K8s
Ansible · Terraform · CI/CD · AWS / GCP
Solana · Anchor (smart contracts)

PROJECTS
Hypha — video platform with non-custodial economy

TALKS
Stop Using ORMs // PyCon LT 2026
Rethinking the Stack // PyCon Wrocław 2025
API-centric Web Development with Tornado // Kyiv IT Weekend 2015

Experience

JAN 2025 – NOW

Hypha Technologies Ltd – London, UK

Founder & CTO

Designed and built a complete video-on-demand platform end-to-end — backend, frontend, payments, data processing, and infrastructure.

Implemented non-custodial on-chain payments on Solana via smart contracts for instant settlement without intermediaries.

Built encrypted streaming and 4K HDR transcoding pipelines.

Designed custom bare-metal infrastructure on FreeBSD for performance and cost efficiency; working with the FreeBSD Foundation on a potential case study.

Operating the platform in production; hardening tooling and infrastructure; open-sourcing the best parts.

Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, TimescaleDB, Redis, DuckDB, Solana, Anchor, Solid.js, HTMX, SSE, FreeBSD / Jails, Ansible

OCT 2022 — DEC 2024

Revolut – London, UK

Software Engineer — Experimentation Platform

Designed and built the core infrastructure for Revolut's Experimentation Platform, adopted as the company-wide standard across product and ML teams. Replaced fragmented A/B tooling with a unified, scalable system. Built SDKs and abstractions to reduce complexity and accelerate adoption by product teams.

Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Trino, Kubernetes, Pandas

FEB 2022 — SEP 2022

Software Engineer — Retail Data Science

Core contributor to the design and implementation of Revolut's Feature Store — a centralized system for managing ML features across Data Science teams. Delivered multiple proofs of concept that shaped the production architecture.

Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Trino, Kubernetes, Airflow

DEC 2019 — JAN 2022

Software Engineer — Risks

Built and maintained backend services and backoffice tooling for multiple internal Risk systems, owned end-to-end across Python backend and React/TypeScript frontend.

Python, Flask, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, React, TypeScript

FEB 2017 — AUG 2019

Nextiva – Kyiv, UA / Scottsdale, USA

Software Engineer — Rules Engine

Designed and built a core app and DSL for defining rule conditions — foundation of Nextiva's Rules Engine. Its scheduling library released as the company's first open-source project.

Python, asyncio, aiohttp, RabbitMQ, gRPC, Protobuf, PostgreSQL

NOV 2015 — NOV 2016

B2B Soft – Kyiv, UA / New York, USA

Software Engineer & Tech Lead

Led design and delivery of a greenfield medical platform from the ground up.

Python, Tornado, React, Redux, Kafka, MongoDB, Sphinx, Ansible, AWS

MAR 2015 — NOV 2015

SoftServe – Kyiv, UA / San Jose, USA

Software Engineer

Built telemetry aggregation systems for Cisco Cloud Services.

Python, Logstash, MongoDB, RabbitMQ, OpenStack

FEB 2014 — MAR 2015

Kasta – Kyiv, UA

Software Engineer, Head of Platform Development

Designed and delivered the MVP of a high-load e-commerce successor platform.

Python, Tornado, Elasticsearch, ZeroMQ, Protobuf, PostgreSQL

AUG 2013 — JAN 2014

GetGoing – Kyiv, UA / San Francisco, USA

Software Engineer

Implemented airline seat selection system for a travel startup integrated with Amadeus GDS.

Python, Django, PostgreSQL, Celery, Elasticsearch, Backbone.js

NOV 2012 — AUG 2013

Prom – Kyiv, UA

Backend Developer

Internal services and CRM maintenance, data processing, and third-party API integrations.

Python, Pylons, SQLAlchemy, Celery